a village some two miles off but the ride from here, there, is pretty from the orchards along some part of the road and the corn fields (now waving with wheat ripe for the sicle) clover fields and other cultivation. This week I have not got things in order and it being the fast month (Ramazan) it is difficult to do so, but when I get properly settled I hope to arrange to begin work at sunrise and get back home by twelve o'clock.

Do you ever get away from New York and take journeys in the wild parts of the U. S. or are you always at that highly civilized city pray my dear brother let me know something about you and your goings on.

We have not yet pitched all our tents in the orchard I have hired to live in for the next three months; because, as we are going to remain it is much better to have the tents pitched on raised platforms of earth and plaster about a foot high than on the level ground as is done in marching; when all our tents are pitched, ours will be rather a smart little camp and as this year I have thank God a pretty wife of whom I am very fond and who appears to be equally fond of me I hope to pass the next three months agreeably.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Tehran, September 22, 1852*

We returned into town from our summer residence on the 5th and the climate is agreeable enough, the days hot but the nights mornings and evenings most delightful. I did not enjoy my residence in the country so much as most years both I and my dear wife having been much out of health. Indeed my health has been so bad that it was with difficulty I could carry on my work, the duties of which are rather arduous I mean editor of the state gazette. Just before the downfall of the late Prime Minister[128] I had got things into such train, that I carried on the business without much difficulty, and from having carried it on well during the absence of the court at Ispahan that is during nearly five months, the Prime Minister and also the King had such confidence in me that all I had to do was to go every Monday morning to the minister and ask him if he had any orders with regard to the weeks Gazette and his invariable answer was no, "you carry on the paper exceedingly well act according to your own judgment," except they had some particular articles to publish and then they were always sent to me in due time for the press, and I went away and brought out the paper to the best of my ability. Now the matter is very different. I publish nothing except the foreign news, without the prime minister's[129] having previously revised it, this gives me a great deal of trouble. I have frequently to spend hours sometimes

[128] Mirza Taki Khan, the Amir-i-Nizam, who proved too honest and able for Persian court taste. A palace intrigue cost him first, his post, and shortly after, his life. See Sykes, *History of Persia*, v. 2, p. 345–346.

[129] Mirza Aga Khan, Itimad-u-Dola, the successtor to Taki Khan.

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